Some groups propose a dialogue and demand greater space to influence the bank's policies. Oxfam, for example, has made recommendations to the bank, stating that 'another bank is possible'.[9] In discussions in Fortaleza, some groups argued the need for guidelines and socio-environmental safeguards as criteria in projects financed by the NDB, in order to ensure the minimum of safeguards already achieved in the World Bank, IDB and elsewhere. A step back in the normative sphere would be a setback in the fight for human rights.

Yet it seems necessary to consider the previous experiences more systematically and judge where and when, for example, safeguards and guidelines for projects funded by the World Bank really did guarantee human, social and environmental rights in the territories. It is also important to base strategies upon accumulated experience of struggle over influencing national development banks. In Brazil, NGOs and social movements have carried out for many years the 'BNDES Platform'. Strategies of action and influence against financial actors are not new. The challenge ahead is forging unifying strategies within BRICS around the NDB.

BRICS governments, financial institutions and major economic groups (the *BRICS from above*[10]) progress according to the convergence between the state and capital, as they take forward accumulation strategies that worsen the concentration of wealth. It is necessary to build a true *BRICS from below*, with common strategies to fight for rights and international solidarity from the bases in BRICS countries. It will be successful only if built upon processes of social struggles and common experiences. Fortaleza is still a beginning.

Notes

1. http://www.portaldaindustria.com.br/cni/imprensa/2014/07/1,41230/mais-de-700-empresarios-do-brics-buscam-integracao- economica.html.
2. http://www.portaldaindustria.com.br/cni/imprensa/2014/07/1,41222/grupo-empresarial-propoe-medidas-para-ampliar-negocios-entre- paises-do-brics.html.
3. http://www1.folha.uol.com.br/mercado/2014/07/1485787-empresarios-dos-brics-querem-usar-moeda-local-em-transacoes-comerciais.shtml.
4. Declaração de Fortaleza, http://cut.org.br/sistema/ck/files/DECLARACAO%20DE%20FORTALEZA_FINAL%20(1).pdf.
5. Empresarios dos BRICS querem usar moeda local para transações. *Folha de São Paulo*, 14 July 2014.
6. Declaração de Fortaleza.
7. We can cite, among them, the popular demonstrations against the transport price increases and then the World Cup more generally, struggles against sex tourism, the struggle to preserve the Coco Park (including occupation of the park for weeks), the fight against the construction of an aquarium without an environmental permit, etc.
8. http://www.brettonwoodsproject.org/2014/05/world-bank-push-ahead-global-infrastructure-facility/.
9. The presentation by Oxfam pointed in that direction at the seminar on the bank organised by the Heinrich Boell Foundation in Fortaleza. On recommendations for the New Development